LoopCasts

Marketing and promo

LoopCasts BV · Ghent
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Handbook chapter 05

LOOPCASTS HANDBOOK · CHAPTER 05

Marketing and promo

Internal handbook, chapter 5. Written by Yasmine.

I do everything that makes people find us: the newsletter, social media, thumbnails, landing pages, the occasional discount action. I work Monday to Thursday.

The newsletter

Every Thursday. About 6,200 people receive it: customers, ex-customers and people who signed up through the form on the website.

The list

The list is `newsletter list MASTER.xlsx` in Dropbox. One column with e-mail addresses, one with first names (for about half of them), one with the date they were added (since 2022).

How addresses get in:

- The sign-up form on the website sends me an e-mail ("New newsletter subscriber: ..."). I collect these and paste them into the sheet, usually on Wednesday.
- New customers: once a month I ask Lotte for the orders sheet and copy the new e-mail addresses over. Marieke says that is OK because they are customers.
- Business cards from events. I type them in.

How addresses get out: people reply to the newsletter with "unsubscribe" or "please remove me" or sometimes something less polite. Those replies arrive in my inbox between all the out-of-office replies (there are hundreds every week). I search for them on Wednesday and delete the rows. I am sure I miss some. We have had two angry mails this year from people who said they had unsubscribed three times. One of them mentioned GDPR.

There is no unsubscribe link. Outlook cannot do that.

Writing and sending

1. I write the newsletter in Outlook: what is new this week (I ask Pieter), a tip, sometimes a discount. Writing takes about an hour and a half.
2. Our host allows maximum 100 recipients per e-mail. So I send the newsletter in **batches of 90 addresses in BCC**. 6,200 / 90 = about 69 e-mails. I copy 90 addresses from Excel, paste them in BCC, send, mark the rows in Excel so I know where I am, next.
3. The host also does not like it when you send too many mails in an hour, so I spread it over the afternoon. If I go too fast, the mails bounce and I do not know which batch arrived and which did not.

Sending takes about three hours, every Thursday. I do other things in between but I cannot leave.

Once, in batch 31, I pasted the addresses in CC instead of BCC. 90 people saw each other's e-mail addresses. We apologised.

What I do not know: how many people open it, what they click on, which addresses no longer exist. I see the bounce mails come in, but I do not have time to process them.

Social media

We are on LinkedIn (company page and Marieke's personal profile, which works much better), X, Instagram and YouTube (short teasers).

When a new video is live, Tuesday and Friday:

1. I ask Pieter for the title and what it is about, or I watch the first minutes myself.
2. I write a post for LinkedIn. Then a shorter one for X. Then another one for Instagram with more hashtags and an image in a different size. For YouTube Pieter cuts a teaser of 40 seconds and I write the title and description.
3. I make the images in Canva: same template, different size per platform, change the title by hand.
4. I post everything by hand, on each platform separately. If the video goes live on Friday, when I am not working, I schedule what can be scheduled and Pieter posts the rest from my notes.

About an hour and a half per video, so three hours a week. The text is four times nearly the same, in four tones of voice.

I answer comments and questions under posts when I see them. Course ideas from comments should go on the whiteboard. They mostly do not.

Thumbnails

Canva template. Per video: duplicate, change title, change episode number, change background colour per course, download as PNG, send to Pieter and Tom. Five minutes each, but it interrupts whatever I was doing.

Discount actions

Three or four times a year (Black Friday, back to school, our birthday in May). A discount code does not exist in our system, because there is no system. People write "BLACKFRIDAY" in their order mail and Lotte and Marieke have to remember to apply it on the invoice. After last Black Friday, Marieke spent a full weekend on invoices.

What I would love to know

- Which posts and newsletters actually lead to orders. Right now I have a feeling, not a number.
- Who of our customers is about to leave. Lotte has the end dates, I have the newsletter; we never put them together.